Course Tycoon: what's new in Act III

Build 2026-10-04a. Notes for playtesters.

Act III (the championships) got a big rework. It used to be one day you didn't do anything on. Now it's a three-week build-up and a week of rounds with decisions in all of it.

The big picture

- **Three rungs, in order:** County Open (2 rounds), Regional (3), National (4). The course is shut to the public for every round.
- **Each morning of the week you set the pins** (easy / fair / tough / brutal) on the Championship sheet. You'll see the leader, the score the winner is on pace for, the target, and today's weather beside them.
- **You can watch the field play your course** on the playback.
- **The week is judged on the winning score.** It has to land in a range. Too low (the field took the course apart) fails just as too high does.
- **A minimum course difficulty** is checked on the first morning. Narrower fairways are the cheap way to get there. The course is locked once round 1 starts.
- **Miss it** and you get the base fee only, lose reputation, and the rung goes to someone else for 120 days. Then you can bid again.

The run-up (the three weeks before)

- **Practice round, 11 days out:** the officials play your course and tell you where the winner is likely to finish, as a range. It's a forecast, not a promise, and it tells you in time to fix things.
- **Weather matters to the crew:** drizzle slows them, heavy rain slows them a lot and softens a firm course, and a storm stops work. Read the forecast.
- **Championship events:** a mower dies, a sponsor wants the 18th tee, a green floods, someone complains about a pin. Every championship gets at least one, and week events change how the next round plays. Each choice states its cost.
- **Staffing:** a championship wants about eight groundskeepers. Keeping the course firm costs money every day of the run-up, and the turf can wear out during the week.

Money

> Hosting well roughly pays for itself. It is no longer a money-maker, and a missed week costs real money. The reward is reputation and finishing the act.

- Best-case purses: County $148k, Regional $352k, National $740k.
- The National's crowd bonus is now earnable with cheap hotel amenities (the short course isn't needed).

Also fixed

- The bottom toolbar scrolls on small phones, so "Open the day" is always reachable.
- The starter no longer talks about public golfers on a closed day.
- Hole closures from decision events can't sink a championship; it's always played over the full open course.
- An old save that missed its National gets it back.

Please tell me about

- Does the practice round's forecast feel honest by round 1?
- Does the week feel like it has enough to do each morning, or too much?
- Any event card where the costs, or the effect on the next round, don't match what it says.
- Any number that disagrees between the Championship sheet, the HUD line and the evening report.
- The Regional and National: can you land the winner in range, and is it fun when you can't?

Known limits: the National is a bit of a gamble even when played well (about 3 in 4), and the practice round assumes normal weather.